Oct 19, 2026

Meeting Oct 19, 2026 at 22:08 IST

Meeting records Transcript

Summary

Portal development discussion covering workflow automation and Google Drive integration.

Edition Portal Purpose
Digitalized workflows replace WhatsApp groups to reduce administrative overhead and streamline communication efficiency.

Workflow and Tracking
Automated section management and performance tracking replace unverified forms with concrete activity records.

Storage and Design
Google Drive APIs handle file storage while Microsoft Teams layout inspires user interface mockups.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Development of a Dedicated Edition Portal** The team aligned on building a dedicated digital portal to manage edition workflows and replace WhatsApp groups.
- **Target Timeline for MVP Testing** The participants aligned on completing an MVP by December or January to test the portal and gather feedback during the upcoming edition cycle.

- **Reuse of Existing Backend Database** The participants aligned on utilizing the existing backend database and login credentials from the main website for the new portal.

Next steps

[Shubhi Dixit] Design UI Flow: Create a basic UI mockup and flowchart for the portal including the login process and page flow.

[Vyom Raturi] Send Meeting Notes: Provide the recorded meeting notes to the collaborator to assist with project planning.

[Nishant] Explore Drive Integration: Investigate the implementation of Google Drive access control based on user email addresses from the database.

Details

Project Overview and Purpose of the Edition Portal: Vyom Raturi explained that the primary goal is to digitalize workflows for the publication's editions by developing a new portal, tentatively called the "edition portal," to replace the heavy reliance on numerous WhatsApp groups (ranging from 20 to 25 groups per edition). Vyom Raturi noted that this fragmentation causes significant administrative overhead and coordination challenges for associate editors who must stay active across all groups. The new portal aims to streamline these processes, reduce redundancy by eliminating unnecessary designer or illustrator involvement in unrelated groups, and improve communication efficiency.

Structure of Edition Teams and Roles: Vyom Raturi outlined the hierarchical structure for producing each edition, stating that council heads select nine associates overall across departments (such as development, design, illustrations, and columnists) to lead and review work. Vyom Raturi detailed that third-year and second-year students perform the heavy lifting and actual creation, while third-year students and associates focus on supervision and reviews. Vyom Raturi mentioned that associate editors bear the most workload because columnists form the central department of the society.

Automated Workflow and Section Management: Vyom Raturi described the proposed automated workflow where Editor-in-Chiefs initialize a new edition on the portal, council heads appoint associates, and system permissions are automatically configured. Vyom Raturi explained that standard sections like student news, faculty news, alumni news, society news, and interviews will be autonomously pre-populated so that assignees can be added directly without manual searching. Vyom Raturi added that non-standard sections, such as varying pulses, can be added manually using a create section feature.

Performance Tracking and Annual Reviews: Vyom Raturi highlighted that the portal will track efforts throughout the year to solve the difficulty of evaluating performances for large verticals, replacing unverified Google forms with concrete activity records. Vyom Raturi explained that these performance records will help leadership make critical end-of-year decisions regarding retention, role assignments, and promotions. Vyom Raturi also mentioned that other standard activities throughout the year, such as logos, winter/spring projects, and platform-specific content (Instagram, YouTube, and LinkedIn), could later be incorporated into the portal.

Development Timeline and MVP Goals: Vyom Raturi stated that the immediate objective is to build a Minimum Viable Product so that it can be tested starting around December or January, coinciding with the next edition team announcement. Vyom Raturi explained that running the portal in parallel with a single WhatsApp group during the January to March period will allow the team to gather valuable user feedback and refine the interface. Vyom Raturi noted that merging the new portal with the main website's existing backend and database will be straightforward and quick once the edition MVP is proven successful.

Google Drive Integration and File Storage: Vyom Raturi and Shubhi Dixit discussed file storage solutions, deciding that Google Drive will be used via Google Drive APIs to store edition files rather than straining database storage. Vyom Raturi explained that creating an edition on the portal will automatically replicate a standard folder structure on Google Drive with subfolders for each department (columnists, photography, designers, and illustrators). Vyom Raturi and Shubhi Dixit debated access controls, initially considering public open access but ultimately agreeing that sharing access via database emails with editor permissions or controlled ID-based sharing is necessary to manage permissions securely.

UI/UX Design and Next Steps: Vyom Raturi explained the planned user interface, which features a basic Microsoft Teams-style layout with a left sidebar and a clean content screen on the right to keep user flow simple and intuitive. Vyom Raturi requested that Shubhi Dixit work on finalizing the user flow, basic login steps, and UI mockups over the upcoming days, aiming for a review meeting by Saturday. Vyom Raturi offered to send recorded notes and past project information to assist Shubhi Dixit with the design process, encouraging them to freely incorporate comprehensive features into the initial drafts.

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